

Task 2: Client Profitability and Spread Recommendation

1. Client Classification and Quantitative Evidence

Based on the aggregate expected PnL (eq. 6) across the six time horizons:

- Client A: Profitable (Agg PnL = 1.89)
- Client B: Profitable (Agg PnL = 1.63)
- Client C: Profitable (Agg PnL = 1.17)
- Client D: Profitable (Agg PnL = 0.30)
- Client E: Costly (Agg PnL = -0.40)
- Client F: Costly (Agg PnL = -1.44)

Clients A, B, C, and D generate positive expected PnL on average, meaning the LP's bid-ask spread captures enough margin to overcome any adverse price drift from their trades. Clients E and F, however, are highly toxic; the market moves against the LP so severely after trading with them that the standard spread is insufficient, resulting in a net loss.

2. Minimum Half-Spread (δ^*) and Adversity Profile

The recommended minimum half-spread δ^* required to break even on aggregate flow is:

- Client A: -0.0117
- Client B: -0.0079
- Client C: -0.0020
- Client D: 0.0096
- Client E: 0.0189
- Client F: 0.0328

(Note: A negative δ^* theoretically implies the LP could quote inside the mid-price and still break even, reflecting highly benign flow. In practice, the LP would quote positive spreads to maximize profit).

Relationship to Adversity Profile from Task 1:

The required δ^* directly correlates with the adversity profiles established in Task 1.

- Client F had the highest adversity percentage (~62% at $\tau=30$), leading to severe adverse selection costs. Thus, Client F requires the widest minimum half-spread (0.0328) to compensate for these expected losses.
- Conversely, Client A had the lowest adversity profile (~41%), meaning their flow does not systematically predict adverse market movements. Consequently, they require the smallest (even negative) δ^* to break even.

This demonstrates that adversity profiles are a reliable proxy for client toxicity and expected profitability, directly dictating the risk premium (wider spreads) the market maker must charge.